

Access Oxbridge Student Onboarding Guide

Everything you need to get set up and matched with your mentor



Welcome to Access Oxbridge. We're delighted to have you with us and can't wait to help you on your academic journey. This guide walks you through setting up your account on our digital platform and ultimately getting you matched with your mentor. It also explains everything we need from you for this process to be as swift as possible. Please read it in full before you begin, then complete all the steps below. Getting your profile finished is the most important first step, as it's what allows us to match you with the right mentor for you.

Your Onboarding Checklist

1. Logged in with the username and password provided
2. Completed your profile in full
3. Read the "What to Expect" section below
4. Started collating documents for your mentor

Getting Started on the Portal

Step 1: Log In

Log in to the portal using the username and password you were provided with. If you haven't received your login details, or you're having trouble accessing your account, contact us and we'll get this sorted for you straight away.

Step 2: Complete Your Profile

Before we can match you with a mentor, your profile needs to be complete. Your profile is what we use to pair you with the best possible mentor, so the more detail you give us, the better the match. A half-finished profile can slow things down, so do take the time to fill it in properly. You can always update it later as things change.

What to Expect Over the Next Week

Once your profile is complete, here's what happens next:

We Start Matching You With a Mentor

As soon as your profile is finished, our team will begin the work of matching you with a mentor. This usually takes a maximum of five to seven working days, though we'll always aim to do it sooner where we can. We will keep you updated by email throughout and let you know as soon as your match is ready.

What you can do in the meantime

While we're busy matching you up, the most useful thing you can do is start collating all the relevant documents and information your mentor might need. This could include:

- A first draft of your personal statement
- Any specific problems or topics you'd like to cover in your first session
- Anything you've been struggling with at school that's relevant to your application
- Any practice admissions tests you've completed
- A list of the books you're currently reading, or any wider reading you've done

Having all of this ready means you and your mentor can hit the ground running as soon as you're matched.

You and Your Mentor Introduce Yourselves

Once you've been matched, your mentor will introduce themselves via the Messages section of the portal, and we encourage you to do the same. Your mentor will likely ask you some questions about where you currently are with your application and what you'd like to cover in your first session, so it's a great chance to start telling them about your goals.

You Book Your First Session

Once you've had a chat, you and your mentor can arrange a time that works for both of you. You can then use the Book a Session function to request hours, or if your mentor sets it up, you can simply accept the request. Once it's confirmed, you're ready to begin.

Use the Messages Function as Much as You Like

Don't wait until your first session to start talking. Use the messaging function on the portal as much as you like to get to know your mentor, give them as much information about your application as possible, and attach any documents you think would help them understand where you are. The more groundwork you both do beforehand, the more productive your first session will be.

If you have any questions about the portal or anything in this guide, please get in touch at any point; we're here to support you every step of the way.